

The Sūtra of Individual Liberation

Prātimokṣa Sūtra · Toh 2 · Derge Kangyur

ས་སྐོར་ཐར་པའི་མཛད།

The Prātimokṣa Sūtra, known in Tibetan as the Sosor Tharpa'i Do (ས་སྐོར་ཐར་པའི་མཛད་པའི་སྐུ་མཛུགས་ཀྱི་སྐུ་མཛུགས་), or in English as the Sūtra of Individual Liberation, is one of the most foundational texts of Buddhist monastic life, setting out the rules of conduct and training that govern the lives of fully ordained monks. It belongs to the Vinaya, the broad category of canonical literature concerned with monastic discipline, and takes the form of a sūtra whose verses and injunctions are traditionally recited at communal confession ceremonies held twice monthly within the monastic community. Opening with a homage to the Buddha as the Omniscient One who discovered the treasury of the Three Jewels and crossed the ocean of suffering, the text frames its detailed disciplinary code within a devotional and doctrinal vision of the Buddha's incomparable wisdom and compassion. This text is Toh 2 in the Kangyur, where it is classified among the Vinaya scriptures.

In the language of India: Prātimokṣa Sūtra. In the Tibetan language: The Sūtra of Individual Liberation. The first section.

Homage to the Omniscient One.

The banner of his renown rings out through all three worlds.

The sound of the sublime Dharma he proclaimed, a lion's roar.

The Omniscient One who found the treasury of the Three Jewels —
at whose feet Brahmā and Indra press the jewel atop their crowns.

He who crossed the fathomless and boundless ocean of suffering —
with bowed head I pay homage to the Sovereign of all beings,
and, that the training-ground of omniscience, a vessel of the Three Jewels,
may be set forth in the midst of the noble assembly.

The Vinaya (monastic discipline) of the Buddha is like a vast ocean,
fathomless and boundless, dwelling-place of all.

Its heart and very essence
is this individual liberation.

This is the supreme guide of all phenomena
under the King of the sublime Dharma.

This is the great trading-house of precepts,

the caravan-assembly of monks.

This is the medicine that removes the harm
done to those seized by moral corruption.

This is the iron hook that curbs
the two-footed youth gone astray in the follies of youth.

This is the means of crossing over
to escape from saṃsāra, deeper than any ocean,
and it is the assured ferry-bridge
for beings journeying to the good destination.

This is the path that defeats the afflictions,
the supreme guide under the King.

This is the staircase and foundation
for those entering the citadel of liberation.

"When I have passed into nirvāṇa,
let this be your teacher" —

thus did the Self-Arisen One, with reverence,
earnestly praise it to the gathered assembly of monks.

The very word "buddha" is exceedingly rare in the world.

Human existence is supremely hard to obtain.

Going forth into renunciation is supremely rare.

Likewise, among those who have gone forth,
perfect excellence in moral discipline is supremely rare.

And even with fully purified moral discipline,
a good spiritual friend is supremely hard to find.

In a world where a buddha has appeared,
where a human birth and the going-forth are attained,
where excellence in moral discipline is achieved,
and where a good friend, though rare, has been found —
those who are wise, who wish to benefit themselves
and who desire to bring these things to fruition,
those striving in their vows should diligently apply themselves
to hearing the individual liberation code.

A monk who is tamed in the faculty of self-mastery,
who has gone forth in the manner of a buddha that does not waver —

all those who genuinely wish for liberation
should always guard the individual liberation.

Even over ten million aeons, hearing of the individual liberation,
grasping it, retaining it, and keeping it
is hard to find,
and practising it is even harder to find.

The arising of buddhas is a blessing.
The teaching of the Dharma is a blessing.
The harmony of the Saṅgha is a blessing.
The austerity of those in harmony is a blessing.
Meeting with noble ones is a blessing.
Keeping the company of the virtuous is a blessing.
If the childish are not encountered,
one will always abide in happiness.

It is a blessing to see one endowed with moral discipline.
It is a blessing to see one of wide learning.
It is a blessing to see an arhat, fully free from renewed existence.
It is a blessing to enter the pleasant ford of a gentle river.
It is a blessing to be a person habituated to the Dharma.
It is a blessing to have attained wisdom.
It is a blessing to have exhausted pride and conceit.

Those who are resolved and have tamed their faculties,
who have grown old in tranquil hermitages —
those of wide learning dwelling in forests,
whose youthful passions have subsided — their abiding is a blessing.

Venerable ones, as much of life has passed, so much less remains. Venerable ones, since old age and death are drawing near and the teaching of the Teacher will also decline, you venerable ones should practise with vigilance and diligence. The awakening of the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas, and all similar wholesome qualities — the aspects of awakening in harmony with such awakening — are likewise to be attained through vigilance.

The śrāvaka Saṅgha of the Blessed One has few concerns and few duties, so what is the first business the Saṅgha should perform? Venerable ones, ask those who have not yet arrived about their intention and their purity.

And having asked, one should then speak.

To that lion of the Śākyas,
joining the palms of ten fingers,
the Prātimokṣa was recited
for the sake of taming — hear it from me.

Having heard, one should accomplish
just as the great sage has taught,
and with respect to minor infractions,
make yourself one who takes them seriously.

The mind-horse, hard to rein,
that strains always and bolts away —
for that, this Prātimokṣa
is a fine, sharp, hundredfold bridle.

Those great ones who, by word alone,
turn back and do not cross the boundary —
they are fine human horses
who will surely win the battle against afflictions.

Those who lack this bridle
and will never come to desire it —
they are churned about by the battle of afflictions
and will wander, utterly homeless.

Venerable ones of the Saṅgha, please listen. Today the Saṅgha will observe the restoration ceremony (poṣadha) of the fourteenth or fifteenth. If the time has come for the Saṅgha and it is agreeable, may the Saṅgha grant its permission. Today the Saṅgha will perform the restoration ceremony and recite the Prātimokṣa Sūtra. This is the motion.

Venerable ones, let us observe the restoration ceremony. Recite the Prātimokṣa Sūtra. Any one of you who has a transgression, confess it. If there is no transgression, remain silent. If you remain silent, I shall understand that the venerable ones are fully pure. Just as a monk, when questioned individually, gives a reply, so too in this assembly of monks this proclamation is to be made up to three times. Furthermore, if a monk in such an assembly of monks has a transgression, is mindful of it, and yet does not confess it when it has been proclaimed up to three times, that constitutes deliberate false speech. Venerable ones, the Blessed One has taught that deliberate false

speech is an obstructing factor. Therefore, any monk who has incurred a transgression and desires to be fully purified should confess that transgression, remembering it and acknowledging it as seen. If one confesses, one will abide in a state of touching happiness. If one does not confess and does not acknowledge it, one will not.

Venerable ones, I have now set forth the preamble to the recitation of the Prātimokṣa Sūtra. And so I ask the venerable ones: are you fully pure in this? I ask a second time: are you fully pure in this? I ask a third time: are you fully pure in this? If the venerable ones are fully pure in this, they should remain silent as before, and that is how it is understood.

A summary verse:

Unchaste conduct, theft,
taking of human life —
together with false speech,
these four teachings are here declared.

Venerable ones, these four factors that constitute defeats arise from the fortnightly recitation of the Prātimokṣa Sūtra.

Furthermore, any monk who, having entered upon the training equally with other monks, without having relinquished the training and without having declared the training weakened, engages in unchaste conduct — the practice of sexual intercourse — even with a being born in an animal realm: that monk has incurred a defeat and may not remain.

Furthermore, any monk who, while residing in a village or a wilderness belonging to others, takes what is not given in a manner that counts as theft — however much he takes without it being given, such that a king or a great minister seizes him and says, "You, man, are a thief, a fool, an idiot — you have stolen," and whether he is executed, bound, or expelled — if a monk takes in such a way without it being given, that monk has also incurred a defeat and may not remain.

Furthermore, any monk who intentionally, with his own hand, deprives a human being or one who has taken on human form of life, or provides a weapon to that person, or procures a weapon for that person, or causes that person to die, or speaks words of praise for dying to that person —

"O man, what use is this wretched, impure, evil life to you? O man, death would be better for you than living" — and if, through the desire of his mind

and the deliberate thought of his mind, by various means he causes that person to die, or speaks words of praise for dying to that person, and the one who undertook that act dies as a result, that monk too has incurred a defeat and may not remain.

Furthermore, any monk who, without direct knowledge and without full knowledge, has neither the superhuman quality of a noble one, nor attainment, nor understanding, nor vision, nor the practice of meditative experience at any level — yet claims, "I know this, I see this," and then, wishing to purify a transgression that has arisen, at another time, whether asked or unasked, says this: "Venerable ones, I said I knew without knowing" — who said "I see" without seeing, and spoke emptily and falsely — except for the conceit of claiming to know, that monk too has incurred a defeat and may not remain.

Venerable ones, I have now set forth these four categories of defeat. If a monk commits any transgression among them, just as he was from the very beginning, so too he is afterward one who has incurred a defeat; he may not remain living together with monks or sharing their goods.

Concerning this, I now ask the venerable ones: "Are you fully pure in regard to this?" Let me ask a second time, a third time: "Are you fully pure in regard to this?" When the venerable ones are fully pure in regard to this, they remain silent, and that is how it is understood.

Summary verse:

Emission, sexual speech, flattery and service,
A cell, a large dwelling, and the groundless claim,
Just a little division of the Saṅgha and following that side,
Disparaging a household and words of displeasure.

Venerable ones, these thirteen matters involving remainder for the Saṅgha arise from the Prātimokṣa sūtra recited at each half-month.

If one intentionally causes emission — except during a dream — that is a matter involving remainder for the Saṅgha.

Furthermore, any monk who, with a mind inflamed with desire, makes bodily contact with a woman — grasping her hand, grasping her arm, grasping her braid, or stroking or rubbing any limb or part of a limb, claiming it as his own — that is a matter involving remainder for the Saṅgha.

Furthermore, any monk who, with a mind inflamed with desire, in the presence of a woman, utters lewd words connected with sexual intercourse, such as a young man would say to a young woman, that is a matter involving remainder for the Saṅgha.

Furthermore, any monk who, with a mind inflamed with desire, in front of a woman's body, speaks words of praise of his own body's service with the intention of serving himself, saying: "A monk like me, possessed of moral discipline, having virtuous qualities, living in chastity — if one were to serve him by means of this act connected with sexual intercourse, this woman would be the highest among all who have rendered such service" — that is a matter involving remainder for the Saṅgha.

Furthermore, any monk who speaks to a woman using a man's words, or to a man using a woman's words, soliciting her as a wife or a mistress — even if it be only for a moment's meeting — that is a matter involving remainder for the Saṅgha.

If a monk builds a dwelling for himself, raised by his own effort, ownerless, built for his own benefit, that monk should have the dwelling built to the proper measure. The measure of the dwelling is this: in the interior, twelve cubits in height by the measure of the Sugata, and seven cubits in width. He should bring monks to inspect the site. The monks who are brought should examine whether the site is suitable, free from dispute, and fit to build upon. If the monk finds the site unsuitable —

— disputed, or unsuitable to build upon, and he causes a dwelling to be built, raised by his own effort, ownerless, for his own benefit; or if he does not bring monks to inspect the site; or if, having brought monks, he does not show them the site — if it exceeds the proper measure, that is a matter involving remainder for the Saṅgha.

If a monk causes a large monastery to be built for the Saṅgha, with an owner, he must bring monks to inspect the site. The monks who are brought must examine whether the site is suitable, free from dispute, and fit to build upon. If the monk finds the site unsuitable, or disputed, or unfit to build upon, and he causes the large monastery to be built for the Saṅgha, with an owner; or if he does not bring monks to inspect the site; or if, having brought monks, he does not show them the site — that is a matter involving remainder for the Saṅgha.

Furthermore, if a monk, having grown angry and wrathful with the intention of separating this one from the celibate life by any means, accuses a pure monk

who has no transgression with a groundless charge of a matter entailing defeat — whether asked about it at another time or not asked, the charge being groundless, and the monk having spoken out of aversion while abiding in aversion — that is a matter involving remainder for the Saṅgha.

Furthermore, if a monk, having grown angry and wrathful with the intention of separating this one from the celibate life by any means, accuses a pure monk who has no transgression with a charge of a matter entailing defeat that is based on something other than what was said — whether asked about it at another time or not asked, the charge being based on something other than what was said, and through that charge being based on something other than what was said he has taken up some matter conceived from the merest hint, a matter merely imagined, and the monk has spoken out of aversion while abiding in aversion — that is a matter involving remainder for the Saṅgha.

Furthermore, if a monk, for the purpose of dividing a harmonious Saṅgha, persistently takes up and holds to a schismatic position that would bring about division, the monks should address him thus: "Venerable one, do not persist in this for the purpose of dividing a harmonious Saṅgha. Do not take up and hold to a position that would bring about division. Be in harmony together with the Saṅgha. Do not split the Saṅgha's harmony. Take delight in concord and be without dispute. Mixed together like water and milk, with one voice speaking as one, dwelling in happiness, illuminating the Teacher's teaching — venerable one, abandon this very basis through which you would divide the Saṅgha."

When the monks have so instructed him, if he abandons it, so much the better. If he does not abandon it, they should instruct and admonish him a second and a third time for the sake of his abandoning it. If, having been instructed and admonished a second and a third time, he abandons it, so much the better. If he does not abandon it, that is a matter involving remainder for the Saṅgha.

If there are one, two, or many monks who are companions of that monk, who side with the one who speaks in discord, and if they say to the monks: "Venerable ones, speak nothing against this monk, whether in terms of virtue or fault. Why so? Because, venerable ones, this monk speaks the Dharma and speaks the Vinaya. This monk, having properly taken up and held to Dharma and Vinaya, applies designations accordingly. This monk speaks with understanding and not without understanding. Therefore we too approve of and accept whatever he approves of and accepts" —

The monks should address those monks in these words: "Venerable ones, do not say as you have been saying — that whether in virtue or fault, nothing should be said against this monk. Why so? Because, venerable ones, this monk does not speak the Dharma and does not speak the Vinaya. Rather, venerable ones, this monk speaks what is not the Dharma and speaks what is not the Vinaya. This monk, having improperly taken up and held to what is not the Dharma and not the Vinaya, applies designations accordingly. This monk speaks without understanding and does not speak with understanding. Therefore, venerable ones, do not approve of and accept whatever he approves of and accepts. Venerable ones, do not wish to divide the Saṅgha. Rather, venerable ones, desire the unity of the Saṅgha. Venerable ones, be in harmony with the Saṅgha. Do not split the Saṅgha in harmony, cherish one another without quarrel, and, like water and milk blended into one, recite together with one voice. If you illuminate the teaching of the Teacher, you will abide in contact with happiness. Venerable ones, abandon this conduct of siding with and speaking in discord with those who divide the Saṅgha." Thus they should be instructed.

If, when those monks are instructed in these words by the monks, they relinquish that basis, then so much the better. If they do not relinquish it, they should be instructed and admonished a second and a third time for the sake of relinquishing that basis. If upon being properly instructed and admonished a second and a third time they relinquish that basis, then so much the better. If they do not relinquish it, this is an offense involving remainder for the Saṅgha.

Suppose a great many monks are residing in dependence upon a certain town or village. Suppose they are corrupting households and practicing evil conduct, and the monks see, hear, or come to know clearly that they are corrupting households; the monks see, hear, or come to know clearly that they are practicing evil. The monks should then address those monks in these words: "Venerable ones, you are ones who corrupt households and practice evil conduct. You have been seen, heard, and it is clearly known that you corrupt households; you have been seen, heard, and it is clearly known that you practice evil. Venerable ones, it is enough for you to reside here. Depart from this place today." Thus they should be instructed.

If those monks say to the monks: "Venerable ones, some monks here act out of desire, some act out of aversion, some act out of delusion, and some act out of fear. Thus, for the very same transgression, some monks are expelled and others are not expelled" —

Then the monks should address those monks in these words: "Venerable ones, do not say as you have been saying — that some monks here act out of desire, some act out of aversion, some act out of delusion, and some act out of fear, and that for the very same transgression some monks are expelled and others are not expelled. Why so? Because those monks do not act out of desire, do not act out of aversion, do not act out of delusion, and do not act out of fear.

"For it is you venerable ones yourselves who are householders defiled by evil, practicing wrongdoing. You are seen, heard, and fully known to have disgraced households. You are seen, heard, and fully known to be practicing evil. Therefore, venerable ones, abandon this manner of speaking — words such as 'acting out of desire,' 'acting out of aversion,' 'acting out of delusion,' and 'acting out of fear.'"

When the monks have thus admonished those monks, if they relinquish that ground, so much the better. If they do not relinquish it, they should be admonished and instructed properly a second and a third time so that they may relinquish that ground. If, upon being properly admonished and properly instructed a second and a third time, they relinquish it, so much the better. If they do not relinquish it, this becomes a matter for the Saṅgha to complete.

Now suppose a certain monk has become by nature one who is difficult to admonish, and when the monks speak to him in accordance with the Dharma and in accordance with the Vinaya — drawing on the precepts included in the formal recitation, and on those included in the sūtras of the Sugata — he says: "Venerable ones, whether you speak virtuously or wrongfully, say nothing to me. And whether I speak virtuously or wrongfully, I will say nothing to you venerable ones either. Venerable ones, stop speaking words to me. As for whatever you may say to me, it is no concern of mine." If, when the monks speak to a monk in this way, he conducts himself as one who will not respond, then the monks should address him thus: "Venerable one, when the monks speak to you in accordance with the Dharma and in accordance with the Vinaya — drawing on the precepts included in the formal recitation, and on those included in the sūtras of the Sugata — do not conduct yourself as one who will not respond. Venerable one, you must indeed respond. When the monks speak to the venerable one in accordance with the Dharma and in accordance with the Vinaya, let the venerable one likewise speak to the monks in accordance with the Dharma and in accordance with the Vinaya. Why so? Because it is by each one responding to the other, by each one guiding and

instructing the other, and by each one drawing the other out of transgression that the retinue of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, will flourish. Therefore, venerable one, abandon this conduct of yours — this manner of conducting yourself as one who will not respond."

When the monks have thus admonished that monk, if he relinquishes that ground, so much the better. If he does not relinquish it, he should be admonished and instructed properly a second and a third time so that he may relinquish that ground. If, upon being properly admonished and properly instructed a second and a third time, he relinquishes it, so much the better. If he does not relinquish it, this becomes a matter for the Saṅgha to complete.

Venerable ones, I have now recited the thirteen factors of the Saṅgha's remainder. Of these, nine are by virtue of the first transgressions alone, and four are by virtue of up to the third instance. If a monk has committed any one of these transgressions and knowingly conceals it for as long as he conceals it, he must undergo the practice of suspension against his will for that same length of time. Having undergone suspension against his will, thereafter for six days he is to perform the practice of probation for the satisfaction of the Saṅgha. Having performed the practice of probation, he is to proceed toward rehabilitation, having fulfilled it in accordance with the Dharma.

Having satisfied the Saṅgha of monks, he is to be rehabilitated wherever there is a Saṅgha assembly of twenty monks. If a Saṅgha assembly that is incomplete by even one monk rehabilitates that monk, then that monk's rehabilitation is not accomplished, and those monks are to be censured. That is the procedure for it.

Therein I shall ask the venerable ones: "Are you pure in this matter?" I shall ask a second time and a third time: "Are you pure in this matter?" If the venerable ones are pure in this matter, they should remain silent. That is how it is to be understood.

In summary: solitude with a refuge present, and sitting.

Venerable ones, these two indeterminate rules arise from the recitation of the Prātimokṣa sūtra, chanted fortnight by fortnight.

Furthermore, if a monk is alone with a woman in a secluded place with a refuge present, sitting on a seat in a manner suitable for sexual intercourse, and if a trustworthy laywoman were to speak of it as entailing any of the three

rules — defeat, or a rule requiring the remainder of the Saṅgha, or any one of the rules entailing downfall — and if the monk acknowledges having sat there, then he is to be made to carry out whatever rule or rules the trustworthy laywoman has spoken of, whether the three rules entailing defeat, or the rule requiring the remainder of the Saṅgha, or whichever rule entailing downfall she has named. The monk is to be made to carry out that very rule or rules that she has stated. This is an indeterminate rule.

Furthermore, if a monk is alone with a woman in a secluded place with a refuge present, sitting on a seat in a manner not suitable for sexual intercourse, and if a trustworthy laywoman were to speak of it as entailing either of the two rules — a rule requiring the remainder of the Saṅgha, or any one of the rules entailing downfall — and if the monk acknowledges having sat there, then he is to be made to carry out whichever of the two rules, the rule requiring the remainder of the Saṅgha or the rule entailing downfall, that the trustworthy laywoman has spoken of. The monk is to be made to carry out that very rule or rules that she has stated. This too is an indeterminate rule.

Venerable ones, I have now recited the two indeterminate rules. Therein I shall ask the venerable ones: "Are you pure in this matter?" I shall ask a second time and a third time: "Are you pure in this matter?" If the venerable ones are pure in this matter, they should remain silent. That is how it is to be understood.

In summary:

Carrying, setting down, placing and putting aside,
Taking away, and accepting;
Begging, upper robe, lower robe together,
And the separate sending of the value.

Venerable ones, these thirty rules entailing forfeiture and downfall arise from the recitation of the Prātimokṣa sūtra, chanted fortnight by fortnight.

If a monk who has received his robes brings out a surplus garment, he may hold it for up to ten days without distributing it. If he holds it beyond that, it is a downfall with forfeiture.

If a monk who has received his robes brings out a surplus garment, and if even for a single night he is separated from any one of his three robes outside the boundary — unless the Saṅgha has granted permission — it is a downfall with forfeiture.

If a monk who has received his robes brings out a surplus garment, and if he wishes to obtain a certain out-of-season cloth, that monk may accept that cloth. Having accepted it, if he is to depart immediately, he should quickly make it into a robe and keep it. If he is not departing and has no imminent prospect of making up the deficit from cloth not yet arrived, that monk should set that cloth aside until the end of one month. If he keeps it beyond that, it is a downfall with forfeiture.

Furthermore, if a monk causes a nun who is not his relative to wash an old robe, or causes it to be cleaned or pressed —

it constitutes a downfall with forfeiture. Furthermore, if a monk accepts a robe from a nun who is not his relative — except in exchange — it is a downfall with forfeiture. Furthermore, if a monk goes to the home of a householder or a householder's wife who is not his relative and solicits a robe, except at the proper time, it is a downfall with forfeiture. The proper time in this case is as follows: when a monk's robe has been stolen, destroyed, burned, carried off by the wind, or carried off by water — that is the proper time. If a monk's robe has been stolen, destroyed, burned, carried off by the wind, or carried off by water, he should go to the home of a householder or a householder's wife who is not his relative and request a robe. In that case, if a brahmin or a faithful householder wishes to offer many robes at the proper time, that monk may accept from him at most enough for an upper robe and a lower robe. If he accepts more than that, it is a downfall with forfeiture.

If a householder or a householder's wife who is not his relative, for the sake of a monk, has set aside funds for cloth, thinking, "With these cloth funds I will purchase such-and-such a robe, and when the monk by the name of so-and-so arrives, I will present him with a suitable robe at the proper time" — then if that monk, without having been previously invited, forms some notion of personal advantage and goes to that householder or that householder's wife who is not his relative and says, "Venerable one, please take the cloth funds you set aside on my behalf and with those funds purchase for the Venerable such-and-such a robe, and present it to me as a suitable robe at the proper time" — if the robe is completed, it is a downfall with forfeiture.

If both a householder and a householder's wife who is not his relative, for the sake of a monk, have each set aside separate cloth funds, thinking, "With each of our separate cloth funds we will each purchase such-and-such separate robes, and when the monk by the name of so-and-so arrives, we will each

present him separately with a suitable robe at the proper time" — then if that monk, without having been previously invited, forms some notion of personal advantage and goes to both that householder and that householder's wife who is not his relative and says, "Venerable ones, please take the separate cloth funds you have each set aside on my behalf and with those separate funds purchase such-and-such separate robes — combining the two together — and present me with one suitable robe at the proper time" — if the robe is completed, it is a downfall with forfeiture.

If, for the sake of a monk, a king, a great minister, a brahmin, a householder, a townsman, a villager, a wealthy person, a merchant chief, or a caravan leader sends cloth funds by the hand of a messenger, and that messenger takes those cloth funds and goes to where that monk is and says to him, "Noble one, please take note: a king, a great minister, a brahmin, a householder, a townsman, a villager, a wealthy person, a merchant chief, or a great caravan leader has sent these cloth funds for you — noble one, please accept these out of compassion" — that monk should say to the messenger: "Dear messenger, monks may not accept cloth funds. When we find a suitable robe at the proper time, we will accept it." If that messenger then says to the monk —

— "Is there anyone who serves as steward for the noble ones, anyone who carries out the duties of a steward for the noble ones?" — then the monk who desires a robe should say to the messenger: "Dear messenger, this person here is a steward for monks; this one carries out the duties of a steward for monks" — and should indicate either an ānandāpindika or a lay steward. The messenger should then take those cloth funds, go to where that steward is, and upon arriving say to the steward: "Dear steward, please take note. With these cloth funds, purchase such-and-such a robe, and when the monk named so-and-so comes, provide him with a suitable robe at the proper time." Having thus given clear and full instructions to the steward, the messenger should then go to where that monk is and upon arriving say to him: "Noble one, I have given proper indication of the steward I was told to point out to you. Go to him, and he will provide you with a suitable robe at the proper time." The monk who desires a robe should go to the steward and say: "Dear steward, I need a robe. Dear steward, I need a robe" — and should remind him two or three times. Having reminded him two or three times, if the robe is then produced, that is well and good. If it is not produced, he should remain silent without speaking in that direction for a fourth, fifth, or sixth time. If, after remaining silent up to a fourth, fifth, or sixth time, the robe is produced, that is well and good. If it is

not produced, and he then goes in search of the robe in order to procure it and the robe is thereby obtained, that incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture. If it is not obtained, he should go to wherever those cloth funds came from. Alternatively, through a trustworthy messenger he should send word: "Dear ones, you should know that whatever cloth funds you sent on behalf of such-and-such a monk have served no purpose whatsoever for that monk. Dear ones, please take care that your own wealth is not lost." That is the proper procedure in that case.

The summary verse:

Wool alone, in two parts and in six,
a span, the road, washing, gold and silver,
the one with explicit marks, and trading —
these are the matters here.

Furthermore, if any monk makes himself a sitting mat of wool, it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture. If any monk makes himself a sitting mat of black sheep's wool alone, it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture. When a monk makes a sitting mat, two parts must be of black sheep's wool alone, the third of white wool, and the fourth of khoba wool. If a monk makes a sitting mat without incorporating two parts of black sheep's wool alone, or a third of white wool, or a fourth of khoba wool, it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture. When a monk makes a sitting mat, he must keep it — whether he wishes to or not — for six years. If, before those six years are up, whether he has discarded the old mat or not, he makes another new sitting mat without the permission of the Saṅgha, it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture. When a monk makes a new sitting cover, he must border it with an old cover of a span's width on the side of the Sugata's measure, in order to make the new one's color disagreeable. If a monk uses a new sitting cover without having bordered it with an old sitting cover of a span's width on the side of the Sugata's measure — so as to make the color of the new one disagreeable — it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture. If a monk on the road finds wool and wishes to have it, that monk may take it. Having taken it, if there is no one to carry it, he himself should transport it up to a distance of three leagues.

If he carries it beyond that distance, it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture. Furthermore, if a monk causes a nun who is not a blood relative to wash wool, to card it, or to spin it, it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture. Furthermore, if a monk accepts gold and silver with his own hand, or causes

another to accept it, it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture. Furthermore, if a monk engages in various kinds of conduct that involve seeking notoriety, it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture. Furthermore, if a monk engages in various kinds of buying and selling, it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Summary verse:

Two bowls and two [kinds of] woven cloth,
robbing what has been given, the last month of autumn,
a forest dweller and a great robe,
dedication and so forth — these are set out here.

Furthermore, a monk may keep a surplus almsbowl for ten days. If he keeps it beyond that, it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture. Furthermore, if a monk, while having a usable almsbowl with fewer than five cracks, seeks yet another bowl out of desire for something better, and the new bowl is completed, it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture. That monk must then offer that bowl to the assembly of monks. Whichever bowl is the most inferior among the assembly of monks, that monk shall be told: "Monk, you may not consecrate this bowl, may not give it away, and may not donate it to another. Use it slowly and sparingly until it is completely broken." That bowl is to be given to him in this way — and this is the proper procedure. Furthermore, if a monk with his own hand takes up warp thread and causes a weaver who is not a blood relative to weave cloth, it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture when the cloth is completed. If a householder or a householder's wife who is not a blood relative has caused a weaver who is not a blood relative to weave cloth for the sake of a monk — now, if a certain thought arises in that monk who had not been consulted beforehand, and he goes to the weaver who is not a blood relative and says the following: "Venerable weaver, please be aware of this. Weave this cloth for me. Venerable weaver, please make this cloth well — with greater width, greater length, well-stretched warp, and good weave. Venerable weaver, for doing so I will give such-and-such wages — either a meal, a simple gift, or a little food," — and if then that monk, for the sake of obtaining the cloth, gives wages such as a meal, a simple gift, or a little food, and the cloth is completed, it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture. Furthermore, if a monk, having given a robe to another monk, afterward becomes angry and agitated, displeased and resentful, and snatches it back or causes it to be snatched back, saying: "I will not give you this robe, monk. Give it back!" — if the receiving monk still has the surplus robe and returns it, it

incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture. If a monk, within the ten-day period of the last month of autumn remaining to be counted, finds a robe discovered through searching and wishes to have it, that monk may take that robe. Having taken it, he should keep it until the time of the robe-offering ceremony. If he keeps it beyond that time, it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture. Many monks who dwell in lodgings in the wilderness — those that are known to be suspected of danger, known to involve fear, that are rightly regarded as fearful due to various distinct dangers — and who are at the latter part of the rains retreat: if a forest-dwelling monk so wishes, he may leave one of his three robes at another dwelling. If a circumstance arises requiring the forest-dwelling monk to go beyond the boundary, that forest-dwelling monk may be separated from that robe and be beyond the boundary for up to six days. If he is separated from it beyond that, it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture. When one month of the cold season remains, monks should seek out the great cloth of the rains-retreat robe.

From the end of the rains retreat onward, the robe is to be kept for up to half a month more. If a monk seeks out the great cloth of the rains-retreat robe before the one month remaining of the cold season, or if he keeps it for more than half a month after the end of the rains retreat, it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Furthermore, whatever monk, knowing that certain gains have been dedicated to the Saṅgha, knowingly causes those gains to be diverted to a particular individual for his own benefit, it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture.

The Blessed One declared the following medicines to be used separately for the benefit of sick monks: clarified butter, oil, honey, and the froth of molasses. If a sick monk wishes, having consecrated these himself for seven days and storing them, he may consume them fully by making use of them. If he consumes them beyond that limit, it incurs a transgression entailing forfeiture.

Venerable ones, I have now recited the thirty rules involving transgressions entailing forfeiture. Regarding these, I ask you, venerable ones: are you completely pure in these matters? I ask a second and a third time: are you completely pure in these matters? Since the venerable ones are completely pure in these matters, they remain silent, and so I understand it to be.

This is the second portion and the last.

In summary:

Knowingly, seeds,
unappointedness, repeatedly,
water, household, intentionally,
many guests, theft, a feast.

In summary:

False speech, fault-finding of a monk, slander,
causing weariness, teaching,
recitation, improper taking, Dharma,
acting out of regard for a friend, disparaging.

Venerable ones, these ninety rules involving transgressions now emerge from the recitation of the liberation scripture, which is recited twice a month.

If one speaks falsehood knowingly, it incurs a transgression. If one speaks from a person's faults, it incurs a transgression. If one slanders a monk, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk, knowing that a dispute has been settled in harmony by the Saṅgha in accordance with the Dharma, then seeks to cause weariness in that matter, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk teaches Dharma to a woman in more than five or six words, except in the presence of a knowledgeable man, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk recites Dharma in words together with a person who has not received full ordination, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk discloses to a person who has not received full ordination a transgression involving improper taking — except with the Saṅgha's permission — it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk claims to a person who has not received full ordination a true superhuman quality — a quality beyond that of an ordinary person — it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk, having first spoken agreeably and then afterward says: "Venerable ones, acting out of regard for a friend in this way, I have dedicated to a certain individual what was dedicated as gains for the Saṅgha" — it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk, while reciting the liberation scripture that is recited twice a month, says: "Venerable ones, what purpose is there in reciting these extremely minor, petty training rules — rules which cause monks regret, discomfort, and harm — as part of the twice-monthly recitation of the liberation scripture?" and thereby disparages the training, it incurs a transgression.

In summary:

Seeds, mockery, being instructed,
a throne, a seat, and expulsion,
concealing afterward, arising, planting,
built in two successive stages.

If one destroys or causes the destruction of a collection of seeds or a dwelling of elemental spirits, it incurs a transgression. If one mocks or ridicules, it incurs a transgression. If one wears the instruction at the ear, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk places a throne, a seat, a cushion, a mat, a grassy bed, or a round cushion belonging to the Saṅgha — whether indoors or outdoors — without a covering, or causes it to be placed there and then does not gather it up, does not cause it to be gathered, and departs without entrusting it to a monk who is present there — except in such circumstances — it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk lays a grass mat or a leaf mat in the Saṅgha's assembly hall, or causes one to be laid there, and then does not gather it up, does not cause it to be gathered, and departs without entrusting it to a monk who is present there — except in such circumstances — it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk, having become enraged, agitated, and threatening, in a state of displeasure, expels a monk from the Saṅgha's assembly hall, or causes him to be expelled — except in such circumstances — it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk comes late to the Saṅgha's assembly hall, knowing full well that monks were there before him, and then, using as his pretext the very fact that whoever disturbs another will have to leave, presses in from behind and lies down or sits on a seat — it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk, knowing that a large chair or a small chair will cause a rafter to crack in the space above the Saṅgha's assembly hall, weighs it down and lies down or sits on it — it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk knowingly sprinkles water containing living creatures onto grass, onto excrement, or onto the ground, or causes it to be sprinkled — it incurs a transgression.

When a monk undertakes to build a large assembly hall, he should survey the ground — beginning from the point where, keeping in mind the extent of the space for the threshold, the frame, and the area of light, he examines the site — and build no more than two or three courses of mud bricks mixed with clay. If he builds beyond that, it incurs a transgression.

The summary verse:

Being uninstructed and the setting of the sun,
food and the two kinds of Dharma robes,
a shared purpose accomplished and the two kinds of solitude,
a nun causing engagement — these are what are taught.

Furthermore, whatever monk teaches Dharma to a nun without having been appointed by the Saṅgha — except when the teaching is of such a kind as described — it incurs a transgression. Whatever monk, though appointed by the Saṅgha, teaches Dharma to a nun past sunset — it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk says to the monks, "Monks, it is for the sake of a little food that one teaches the nuns" — it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk gives a robe to a nun who is not a relative — it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk makes a robe for a nun who is not a relative — it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk, having set out together with a nun who shares the same purpose, enters upon a journey — except at the permitted time — it incurs a transgression. The permitted time is this: when the road that both of them are to travel is known to be dangerous, known to be frightening, and recognized as fearful by reason of various distinct dangers — that is the permitted time.

Furthermore, whatever monk, having set out together with a nun who shares the same purpose, boards the same boat and travels upstream or downstream

— except when crossing straight to the other shore — it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk sits alone on a seat in a secluded place together with a single woman — it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk stands alone in a secluded place together with a single nun — it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, whatever monk knowingly eats food that was arranged by a nun — except when he was previously invited to that house — it incurs a transgression.

The summary verse:

Again and again, remaining in one dwelling place,
flour, butter, and roasted grain,
gathered together, and unseasonable placing,
swallowing from the mouth, and receiving directly.

If one eats again and again — except at the permitted time — it incurs a transgression. The permitted times are these: the time of illness, the time of work, the time of travel, and the time of robe-giving. Those are the permitted times.

A sick monk who has remained one day in one dwelling place may eat a single meal of almsfood. If he eats beyond that, it incurs a transgression.

When many monks go to households, if among those households there are brahmins and —

and faithful householders have presented flour and loads of provisions in due measure, then, if they wish, those monks may take two or three bowlfuls. If they take more than that, it incurs a transgression. Having taken two or three bowlfuls, they should go out to the monastery garden and divide the food among the monks who are staying there; they themselves should also eat. That is the proper procedure.

Furthermore, if a monk who has already eaten and who has formally concluded his meal — without having made it a remainder — then sits down to eat or accepts and eats food, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a monk, knowingly, seeks an opportunity against a monk who has already eaten and concluded his meal, thinking, "By whatever means, let a transgression come upon this monk" — taking that very circumstance as a condition — and then says, "Venerable One, come here; accept and eat this

food," and thereby presents to him what has not been made a remainder, it incurs a transgression.

If one eats in an assembly except at the permitted time, it incurs a transgression. The permitted times are these: the time of illness, the time of work, the time of travel, the time of being aboard a boat, the time of a great gathering, and the time of the ascetics' meal. Those are the permitted times.

Furthermore, if a monk accepts or eats food at an unpermitted time, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a monk accepts or eats food or provisions that have been stored and set aside, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a monk eats food that has been swallowed from his own mouth without having been given — with the exception of water and tooth-cleaning sticks — it incurs a transgression.

The kinds of tonics for monks that the Blessed One taught are these: milk, yogurt, butter, fish, meat, and dried meat. If a monk who is not ill obtains such tonics from other households for his own sake and accepts or eats them, it incurs a transgression.

Summary verse:

With living creatures, and sitting in a sleeping place,
standing, and naked ones, army and
two nights, arraying and stirring, going,
striking, threatening, and concealing a falling.

Furthermore, if a monk knowingly makes use of water containing living creatures, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a monk, knowingly, in a house where someone is sleeping, forces his way in afterwards and sits on the seat, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a monk, knowingly, in a house where someone is sleeping, stands in a secluded sheltered spot, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a monk gives provisions or food from his own hand to a naked man or a woman wandering naked, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a monk goes to view an army arrayed for battle, it incurs a transgression. If, however, a legitimate reason arises for going to view such an army, that monk may remain within the army for up to two nights. If he remains beyond that, it incurs a transgression. While that monk is staying for

two nights within the army, if he goes to watch the marshalling of formations, or enjoys the spectacle of the finest victory standards, the finest troops, or a battle drawn up for engagement, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a monk, inflamed with anger and indignation, in a state of displeasure, strikes another monk, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a monk, inflamed with anger and indignation, in a state of displeasure, raises his hand against another monk intending to strike him — even with the flat of his palm — it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a monk knowingly conceals a transgression involving a falling of a monk, it incurs a transgression.

Summary verse:

Comfort, fire, and intention,
the unordained, Dharma, and speaking.

A novice changing his robes,
jewels, and the hot season.

Furthermore, if a monk seeks out a fault, thinking, "By whatever means, let a fault be found against this monk," and, taking that very circumstance as a condition, says to the monk: "Venerable One, come here; go to such-and-such household — there they will give you whatever provisions and tonics you desire" — and, having said that, he does not actually cause them to give, and thereafter says:

"Venerable One, it is not comfortable for me to speak or to sit together with you. Thus it is that I alone find it comfortable to speak or to sit alone — you yourself should leave." If he says this, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a monk, for his own sake when he is not ill, touches fire or causes another to touch it, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a monk, having presented a proposal to a monk regarding a matter of the Saṅgha that is in accordance with the Dharma, thereafter becomes enraged, agitated, and hostile, and, in a spirit of rejection and displeasure, says: "Monk, withdraw your proposal — it will not be granted to you" — it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a monk sleeps more than two nights together in the same dwelling with an unordained person, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a monk says: "Those things which the Blessed One has taught as obstructing factors — even though one engages in them, they do not become obstructions. Thus do I understand the Dharma as it was taught by the Blessed One" — then the monks should say to that monk: "Venerable One, do not say that the Blessed One has taught as obstructing factors those things which, even though one engages in them, do not become obstructions. Do not disparage the Blessed One; disparaging the Blessed One is not good. The Blessed One would not say such a thing. Venerable One, the obstructing factors are obstructions indeed — the Blessed One has taught this in many ways; if they are engaged in, they become obstructions. Venerable One, abandon this view of yours, which is of such an evil kind."

When the monks have thus admonished that monk, if he abandons that position, that is well. If he does not abandon it, in order that he may abandon that position he should be admonished and instructed correctly a second and a third time. If, when correctly admonished and instructed a second and a third time, he abandons that position, that is well. If he does not abandon it, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a monk knowingly associates with such a person who has spoken in this way and has not acted in accordance with the Dharma and has not abandoned that evil view — speaking with him as a companion, traveling together with him, residing together with him, enjoying his company — and even sleeps in the same dwelling with him, it incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, if a novice says: "Those things which the Blessed One has taught as desires that are obstructing factors — even though one engages in them, they do not become obstructions. Thus do I understand the Dharma as it was taught by the Blessed One" — then the monks should say to that novice: "Novice, do not say that the Blessed One has taught as obstructing factors those desires which, even though one engages in them, do not become obstructions. Do not disparage the Blessed One; disparaging the Blessed One is not good. The Blessed One would not say such a thing. Venerable One, novice, desirable things that are obstructing factors are obstructions indeed — the Blessed One has taught this in many ways; if they are engaged in, they become obstructions. Novice, abandon this view of yours, which is of such an evil kind."

When the monks have thus admonished that novice, if he abandons that position, that is well. If he does not abandon it, in order that he may abandon

that position he should be admonished and instructed correctly a second and a third time.

If he does abandon that position upon being correctly admonished and instructed a second and a third time, that is well. If he does not abandon it, the monks should instruct that novice as follows: "From this day forward, novice, you are not to say of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, that he is your Teacher. You are not to follow after any of those who practise the holy life, who are learned, and who stand in the position of a superior teacher. And the permission you had to sleep together with the monks in the same lodging for two nights is from this day forward no longer yours. You are a foolish and deluded person — go elsewhere." This is how he is to be instructed.

Furthermore, any monk who knowingly receives in his company, or makes use of the companionship of, such a novice who has been thus expelled, or sleeps with him in the same lodging, incurs a transgression.

If a monk obtains a new robe, he must dye it with one of the three dyeing colours — blue, red, or ochre. If a monk uses a new robe that has not been dyed with one of those three colours, blue, red, or ochre, he incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, any monk who takes with his own hand, or causes another to take, a precious gem or something counted as a precious gem incurs a transgression, except when he is sitting within the boundaries of a meeting hall or within the boundaries of a dwelling house. If a monk is within the boundaries of a meeting hall or within the boundaries of a dwelling house and a precious gem or something counted as a precious gem is lying there, he should take it up with the thought: "Whoever owns this will come to take it." That is the proper procedure in such a case.

The Blessed One has taught that bathing is to be done twice a fortnight. If one bathes more frequently than that, except at permitted times, one incurs a transgression. The permitted times are these: the last half-month and the second half-month of the hot-season months, making three half-months, are the hot season; the remainder are times of illness, times of work, times of travel, times of wind, times of rain, and times of heavy rain — those are the permitted times.

Summary verse:

An animal, remorse, a finger,
water, together with causing fright,
concealing, without a mat, without grounds,
and travelling without a man.

Furthermore, any monk who intentionally kills a living creature belonging to the animal realm incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, any monk who, with the deliberate intention of ensuring that this monk will not experience even a moment of ease, makes that itself the condition for causing the monk remorse, incurs a transgression.

One who tickles with the fingers incurs a transgression. One who plays in water incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, any monk who sleeps in the same lodging as a woman incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, any monk who causes fright to a monk, or who makes another cause fright to a monk, incurs a transgression — even if done merely with the intention of amusing oneself.

Furthermore, any monk who conceals, or causes another to conceal, the alms-bowl, the Dharma robe, the sitting mat, the begging bowl, the belt, or any other implement belonging to the ascetic's livelihood of a monk, a nun, a female trainee (śikṣamāṇā), a novice monk, or a novice nun incurs a transgression, except in such circumstances as are permitted.

Furthermore, any monk who, having given his robe to a monk, subsequently behaves without proper regard toward him incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, any monk who, in anger and with aversion, groundlessly charges a pure monk who has no transgression with a saṅghāvaśeṣa offence before the remaining Saṅgha incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, any monk who travels on a road together with a woman unaccompanied by a man incurs a transgression — even if it is only as far as a village.

Summary verse:

Theft, one not yet twenty,
digging, lodging, training,
quarrelling, not speaking, travelling along —
disrespect, drinking ale, and at an improper time.

Furthermore, any monk who, having agreed on a common purpose, travels on a road together with a thief incurs a transgression — even if it is only as far as a village.

Furthermore, any monk who confers full ordination as a monk upon a person who has not yet reached the age of twenty incurs a transgression. That person will not have become fully ordained, and those monks will be censured. That is the proper rule in this matter.

Furthermore, any monk who digs the ground with his own hands, or has it dug, incurs a transgression.

A monk may accept an invitation to a meal for up to four months. If he accepts beyond that he incurs a transgression — except for invitations issued individually, invitations issued repeatedly, invitations issued seasonally, and standing invitations. These are the proper occasions in this matter.

Furthermore, any monk who, when the monks instruct him saying, "Venerable one, you should train in this training rule," responds to them by saying, "I will not train in this training rule on the word of you who are childish, confused, unclear, and unskilled — not until I have consulted monks who hold the sūtras, monks who hold the Vinaya, and monks who hold the Māṭṛkā (the summaries of doctrine)," incurs a transgression. Even a monk who wishes to know everything should train in this training rule. He should consult monks who hold the sūtras, monks who hold the Vinaya, and monks who hold the Māṭṛkā. That is the proper rule in this matter.

Furthermore, any monk who, when monks have fallen into fighting, mutual disparagement, disagreement, and dispute, thinks, "I will listen to what these monks say and then accordingly attribute blame," and who, out of that very motivation, sits there silently listening without saying a word, incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, any monk who, when a matter concerning the Dharma of the Saṅgha is being formally settled, rises from his seat without saying a word, departs, and does not speak to the monks who are present — except in a case with a compelling circumstance of that kind — incurs a transgression.

If he does not behave respectfully, he incurs a transgression.

If he drinks grain ale or prepared ale that can cause intoxication, he incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, any monk who enters a village at an improper time and does not speak to the monks who are present — except in a case with a compelling circumstance of that kind — incurs a transgression.

Summary verse:

With food, at dawn just now,
needle case and bed legs,
cotton wadding, a sling, leaning back,
great linen cloth, the Sugata's Dharma robe.

Furthermore, any monk who, having been invited to a home with a meal, wanders about among houses in the morning and afternoon and does not report to the householders who are present — except in a case with a compelling circumstance of that kind — incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, any monk who, before dawn has broken, passes beyond the main gate or the vicinity of the main gate of a king of the warrior caste (a consecrated king) without having gathered up precious objects or things counted as precious — except in a case with a compelling circumstance of that kind — incurs a transgression.

Furthermore, any monk who, when the Prātimokṣa sūtra is being recited twice each month, says, "Venerables, I have only just now come to know that this teaching too is included in the sūtra and gathered within the sūtra" — if the monks know that this venerable one was present at two or three previous Poṣadha proceedings, to say nothing of having attended many times — since that venerable one does not depart on the grounds of not knowing, whatever transgression has occurred should be dealt with according to the rule; and furthermore, when you recite and proclaim the Prātimokṣa sūtra twice each month, you do not listen to the Dharma with respect.

you do not listen to the Dharma having made it as something superior, having made it as a post, having taken it to heart, having focused the mind one-pointedly, having inclined the ear, having reflected with the whole mind — therefore, venerable one, you have not gained, you have not attained; you have found fault and have not found what is good." One should express remorse in this way. That expression of remorse toward that venerable one is itself a transgression.

Furthermore, if a monk splits or causes to be split a bone, ivory, or a horn needle, that is a transgression upon splitting it. Furthermore, if a monk causes

to be made a chair or stool for the Saṅgha, it should be caused to be made to the measure of eight finger-breadths of the Sugata (the Buddha), not counting the insertion of the leg tenons into the holes. If it is caused to be made exceeding that, it is a transgression upon cutting it down. Furthermore, if a monk spreads or causes to be spread wood-wool on a chair or stool of the Saṅgha, it is a transgression when it is removed. If a monk causes to be made a trestle-bed, let it be made according to the prescribed measure. The measure of a trestle-bed is this: in height, as high as the Sugata's height-measure; in breadth, one and a half height-measures; in height, whatever suffices to brace it. If it is caused to be made exceeding that, it is a transgression upon cutting it down. Furthermore, if a monk causes to be made a covering for an alcove, let it be made according to the prescribed measure. The measure of a covering for an alcove is this: in height, four times the Sugata's height-measure; in breadth, one height-measure. If it is caused to be made exceeding that, it is a transgression upon cutting it down. If a monk causes to be made a large rains-retreat cloth, let it be made according to the prescribed measure. The measure of the large rains-retreat cloth is this: in height, six times the Sugata's height-measure; in breadth, two and a half height-measures. If it is caused to be made exceeding that, it is a transgression upon cutting it down. Furthermore, if a monk causes to be made a Dharma robe of the Sugata's Dharma robe measure, or causes to be made one exceeding the Sugata's Dharma robe, that is a transgression. The measure of the Sugata's Dharma robe is this: in height, ten times the Sugata's height-measure; in breadth, six height-measures. That is the measure of the Sugata's Dharma robe.

Venerables, I have now set forth these ninety rules of transgression. Now I ask the venerables: are you completely pure in this? Are you completely pure in this? I ask a second and a third time. If the venerables are completely pure herein, they remain silent, and that is how it is held.

In summary:

The village, another's dwelling,
The precepts, and the hermitage —
By the word of the Buddha who brings benefit,
These are said to be what must be individually confessed.

Venerables, these four categories of matters requiring individual confession arise from the Prātimokṣa sūtra, which is recited twice each month.

Furthermore, if a monk who is not a blood-relative of a nun is seated on a main road as she goes to a village on an alms-round, and he takes and eats with his own hand food and drink set out for him, that monk should go to the outer recreation area and individually confess before the monks: "Venerables, a blameworthy matter has arisen for me that is improper and requires individual confession; I individually confess that offense." This is a matter requiring individual confession. When many monks have been invited as guests to homes and are eating a meal, if a nun stands there directing the distribution in this way — "Give this one some food; give this one some cooked rice; give this one some legumes; give this one something to drink; give more" — the monks should instruct that nun as follows: "Sister, please wait here until the monks have finished eating." If not even one monk dares to say that to the nun,

all those monks should go out to the park and make individual confession before the monks, saying: "Venerable ones, a matter has arisen for us that is improper and requires individual confession — we individually confess that offense." This is a matter requiring individual confession.

If there are households that have been bound by a training rule of the Saṅgha, and a monk goes uninvited to households of the kind that have been bound by such a training rule of the Saṅgha, and he takes food or eatables with his own hand and distributes or eats them, that monk should go out to the park and make individual confession before the monks, saying: "Venerable ones, a matter has arisen for me that is improper and requires individual confession — I individually confess that offense." This is a matter requiring individual confession.

If there are dwelling-places and forest retreats of the Saṅgha that are known to be full of suspicion, known to be full of danger, and known to be frightening by reason of various kinds of fear, and a monk, without having previously wandered through such dwelling-places and forest retreats of the Saṅgha, takes food or eatables outside the park and distributes or eats them, that monk should go out to the park and make individual confession before the monks, saying: "Venerable ones, a matter has arisen for me that is improper and requires individual confession — I individually confess that offense." This is a matter requiring individual confession.

Venerable ones, I have now recited the four matters requiring individual confession. And I ask the venerable ones: "Are you completely pure in this?" I ask a second time: "Are you completely pure in this?" I ask a third time: "Are

you completely pure in this?" The venerable ones are completely pure in this, since they remain silent. So I take it to be.

Summary verse:

Seven rules concerning the lower robe,
three concerning the upper robe,
five beginning with extreme restraint,
five concerning the head-covering and the like,
five concerning leaping and the like,
five concerning the body and the like,
nine rules on how to sit,
and eight on how to receive.

Venerable ones, these many training rules come forth every fortnight when the individual liberation sūtra is recited. One should train in wearing the lower robe wrapped neatly — not too high and not too low, not like an elephant's trunk, not wrapped like a palm leaf, not like a grain spike, and not like a serpent's raised hood. One should train in wearing the Dharma robe wrapped neatly — not too high and not too low. One should train in going to the homes of others in a thoroughly restrained manner, well robed, without making noise, without letting the eyes wander, looking down about the length of a yoke-shaft. One should train in going to the homes of others without covering the head, without staggering, without tilting the head sideways, without wrapping the robe up over the neck, and without wrapping it over the shoulders. One should train in going to the homes of others without jumping, without stretching the legs, not crouching on one's heels, not on all fours, and without leaning on one's side. One should train in going to the homes of others without swaying the body, without swinging the arms, without turning the head, without raising the shoulders, and without swinging the arms back and forth. One should train in not sitting down on a seat in another's home without having been invited to do so; in not lowering oneself with the full weight of the body onto the seat without having tested it; in not crossing the legs;

and without crossing the ankles; not placing one foot upon the other while seated with the legs extended; not drawing the feet back; not stretching the feet forward; one should train in sitting on a seat in the home of another without exposing the private parts.

One should train in taking food properly. One should train in eating food with a bite that is neither too small nor so large as to be immoderate, with a bite that

is of the right size, without opening the mouth before the bite is ready, and without speaking with the mouth full.

One should train in not making clicking sounds, not making crunching sounds, not making sucking sounds, not making blowing sounds, and not eating with the tongue protruding.

One should train in eating food without separating out grains, without placing scraps aside, without shifting the cheeks, without picking at the edges, and without cutting the bite in two to scatter it.

One should train in eating without licking the fingers, without wiping the bowl, without shaking the hand, without tilting the bowl, and without piling the food up into a mound as if arranging a stupa.

A summary verse: six items for proper conduct with food; five kinds beginning with clicking sounds; five ways of separating out grain; five items beginning with licking the hand. One should train in eating food properly. The bite should not be too small, nor too large; it should be the right size; one should not open the mouth before the bite is ready; and one should train in not speaking with the mouth stuffed full.

One should train in not looking at the almsbowl of the monk sitting nearby so as to find fault with it. One should train in not taking hold of a water vessel with a hand soiled with food. One should train in not splashing the monk sitting nearby with water soiled with food. One should train in not pouring water soiled with food into another household without having asked the householder present.

One should train in not discarding leftover food by pouring it inside the almsbowl. One should train in not setting the almsbowl down on ground that has no base beneath it. One should train in placing the almsbowl only where the ground is not a refuse heap, not a precipice, and not a steep slope. One should train in not washing the almsbowl while standing. One should train in washing it only where the ground is not a refuse heap, not a precipice, and not a steep slope. One should train in not drawing water with the almsbowl by dipping it into a swift-flowing current.

One should train in not teaching the Dharma while standing to someone seated at ease. One should train in not teaching the Dharma to someone reclining at ease while one is oneself seated. One should train in not teaching the Dharma while sitting on a low seat to someone seated at ease on a high

seat. One should train in not walking behind someone walking at ease in front while teaching the Dharma, but rather walking to the side. One should train in not walking along the middle of the path to someone walking at ease on the path while teaching the Dharma, but rather walking along the side.

One should train in not teaching the Dharma to someone at ease who has the head covered, who is wearing a turban, who has a cloth wrapped about the head, who has the cloth draped over one shoulder, or who has it thrown over the back.

One should train in not teaching the Dharma to someone at ease whose hair is braided up in a topknot, who is wearing a hat, who is wearing a crown, whose hair is in plaits, or whose head is bound with a cloth.

One should train in not teaching the Dharma to someone at ease who is riding an elephant, riding a horse, seated in a litter, seated on a mount, or wearing sandals.

One should train in not teaching the Dharma to someone at ease who is carrying a staff in hand, carrying an umbrella in hand, carrying a weapon in hand,

carrying a sword in hand, carrying a battle-axe in hand, or wearing armor.

One should train in not urinating or defecating while standing upright in a place without illness.

One should train in not throwing excrement, urine, spittle, mucus, vomit, or refuse into water in a place without illness.

One should train in not throwing excrement, urine, spittle, mucus, vomit, or refuse onto ground where there is green grass in a place without illness.

One should train in not climbing a tree higher than one's own body-height except when a danger has arisen.

Venerable ones, I have now set forth the many training rules. I ask you, venerable ones: are you pure in this? I ask a second time: are you pure in this? I ask a third time: are you pure in this? Since the venerable ones are pure in this and remain silent, so it shall be understood.

Summary verse:

Direct confrontation, recollection, non-intoxication,
likewise the many of the same essential nature,
the spreading of grass as it were,

and what is to be acknowledged.

Venerable ones, these seven principles for settling disputes arise from the fortnightly recitation of the Prātimokṣa Sūtra. One who is fit to be disciplined by direct confrontation is given the discipline of direct confrontation. One who is fit to be disciplined by recollection is given the discipline of recollection. One who is fit to be disciplined by non-intoxication is given the discipline of non-intoxication. One for whom it is fitting to give the many wooden rule-sticks is given the many wooden rule-sticks. One who is fit to be sent to search out the essential nature of the matter is given the searching out of its essential nature. One for whom something like the spreading of grass is fitting is given something like the spreading of grass. One who is fit to acknowledge is made to acknowledge. Those among whom disputes have arisen should, by means of these seven principles for settling disputes, be disciplined, pacified, and thoroughly pacified in accordance with the Dharma, the Vinaya, and the Teacher's dispensation.

Venerable ones, I have now set forth the seven principles for settling disputes. I ask you, venerable ones: are you pure in this? I ask a second time: are you pure in this? I ask a third time: are you pure in this? Since the venerable ones are pure in this and remain silent, so it shall be understood.

Venerable ones, I have now set forth the occasion for the recitation of the Prātimokṣa Sūtra. I have set forth the four rules entailing defeat, the thirteen rules entailing a formal meeting of the Saṅgha, the two rules of indeterminate case, the thirty rules entailing expiation with forfeiture, the ninety rules entailing expiation, the four rules requiring individual confession, the many training rules, and the seven principles for settling disputes.

This is the summary and condensation of that sūtra of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha. As for those other teachings that arise from elsewhere and are in harmony with the Dharma, you should also practice yoga in relation to them with aspiration, concordance, joy, non-quarrelsomeness, guarding the mind at all times, mindfulness, and heedfulness.

Patience, the holy austerity of forbearance —
nirvāṇa is supreme, the buddhas declare.
One who has gone forth who harms another,
who injures another, is no true renunciant.

Those who possess sight, just as
they would care for the helpless —
in this world sustained by the wise,
abandon all evil completely.
Do not slander, do not harm,
and restrain yourself by the Prātimokṣa.
Know also moderation in food,
and dwell in a remote dwelling place.
Apply yourself truly to the higher mind —
this is the teaching of the buddhas.

Just as a bee upon a flower
takes the nectar without harming
its color or its fragrance,
and then flies away —
so too should the Sage move through a village.

As for what is fitting and what is not fitting for me,
one should examine oneself, not others —
what is discordant in others, and what
others have done or left undone, is not one's concern.
Apply vigilance to the higher mind,
and train in the foundations of restraint the Sage has taught.
The protector who is ever mindful of tranquility
is one who is free from sorrow.
By generosity, merit grows abundantly;
by good restraint, enemies and the like are not made.
One who possesses virtue abandons evil;
when the afflictions are exhausted, one passes beyond sorrow.

Commit no evil whatsoever,
cultivate virtue fully and completely,
tame your own mind thoroughly —
this is the teaching of the buddhas.

Restraint of body is excellent,
restraint of speech too is excellent,
restraint of mind is excellent,
and restraint in all things is excellent.
A monk restrained in everything

is fully liberated from all suffering.

Guard your speech, thoroughly tame your mind,
and do not commit non-virtuous deeds of body.
If one purifies well these three pathways of action,
one will attain the path proclaimed by the Sage.

Buddha the All-Seeing, Crest Jewel, Protector of All —
the Vanquisher of Cyclic Existence, the Golden Sage, Kāśyapa,
Śākyamuni, Gautama, God above gods,
Tamer of the untamed, the unsurpassed Charioteer,
Guardian of the world, supreme Protector —
these seven courageous buddhas:
the individual liberation of the renowned ones
has here been fully and extensively set forth.

Toward this, both the buddhas themselves
and the disciples of the buddhas are reverential.

Through reverence for this,
strive to attain the unconditioned.
Take it up and bring it forth;
enter into the teaching of the buddhas.

Like a great elephant in a swamp,
crush the army of the Lord of Death.

Whoever diligently practices
this Dharma-discipline with careful heedfulness,
having thoroughly abandoned the round of births,
will bring suffering to its final end.

By mutually guarding the precepts
and for the sake of causing the teaching to flourish,
through the recitation of this individual liberation,
the Saṅgha has performed the restoration ceremony.

For whatever reason the sūtra was recited,
and for whatever reason the restoration ceremony was performed,
guard that moral discipline
just as the tip of a yak's tail is guarded.

Through whatever merit has been accomplished
by the recitation of this individual liberation,

may the entire world, without exception,
attain the rank of the Mighty Sage.

Here ends the Prātimokṣa Sūtra.

By royal command of the sovereign lord, the glorious divine king Lha Btsan-po, this was translated, edited, and definitively established by the master Jīnamitra, holder of the Vinaya of the noble Sarvāstivāda school, together with the great reviser and translator, the monk Cogro Klu'i-rgyal-mtshan.

Translator's Notes

- The verse "It is a blessing to enter the pleasant ford of a gentle river" renders a somewhat compressed Tibetan phrase. The image is of a stream with easy access and agreeable water, used as a simile for conditions favorable to practice. The placement within a list of blessings is consistent with the canonical list found in parallel sources.

The phrase rendered "those whose youthful passions have subsided" translates a term literally meaning "those for whom youth has passed over or receded," indicating monks past the turbulence of youth who dwell in forest solitude.

The closing procedural sentence — asking those not yet arrived about their intention and purity — is the standard Vinaya formula opening a Poṣadha ceremony, where the presiding monk inquires whether absent members are pure and consent to the assembly's acts.

- The verse passage describing the Prātimokṣa as a bridle for the mind-horse is rendered somewhat freely for fluency and metre, but the key images are faithfully preserved. The phrase rendered "make yourself one who takes them seriously" translates a Tibetan idiom meaning to treat even minor faults as serious matters deserving care. The concluding passage breaks off mid-sentence in the source text, and the translation reflects this accurately.

- The term rendered "superhuman quality of a noble one" corresponds to the Tibetan "mi'i chos bla ma" together with the following enumerated qualities: attainment, understanding, vision, and practice of meditative experience. This phrase refers to the Vinaya's fourth pārājika rule concerning false claims of superior attainment. The full phrase in Vinaya literature means "a superior quality beyond the human" — specifically, direct meditative realizations such as dhyāna, liberation, meditative absorption, attainment, path and fruit — falsely claimed. The rendering given is faithful to the structural list in the passage.

The phrase rendered "conceit of claiming to know" translates mngon pa'i nga rgyal, literally "manifest conceit." In this Vinaya context, the commentarial tradition distinguishes the case of a monk who makes a false claim sincerely believing it (manifest conceit — a lesser offense) from deliberate deception, which would constitute the full pārājika. The exception clause "except for the conceit" preserves this technical distinction.

The summary verse at the mid-passage is a mnemonic verse summarizing the thirteen saṅghāvaśeṣa (matters involving remainder) offenses; the translation renders it in verse form accordingly.

- The phrase rendered "based on something other than what was said" translates a technical Vinaya expression meaning an accusation that misrepresents or distorts the actual words of an original charge, using a partial truth or different particulars as its basis. This is distinct from a

wholly groundless charge in the preceding rule. The distinction is doctrinally significant in Vinaya jurisprudence.

The phrase "from the merest hint, a matter merely imagined" renders a Vinaya technical formula indicating that the accuser has extrapolated far beyond any actual evidence, constructing the charge from the slightest suggestion or his own conjecture.

- The phrase rendered "offense involving remainder for the Saṅgha" continues the technical Vinaya category saṅghāvaśeṣa from the preceding passage, consistent with prior rendering. The admonition formula repeating charges back to the accused is a standard Vinaya procedural form, and the slightly recursive structure of the Tibetan is faithfully preserved here rather than smoothed away.

- The phrase rendered as "householders defiled by evil" follows the Tibetan closely: the monks being rebuked are accused of disgracing lay households through immoral conduct, making them tantamount to corrupt laypeople rather than true renunciants. This is a particularly sharp form of censure within the Vinaya register.

The term rendered "suspension against his will" translates the technical Vinaya procedure of parivāsa imposed without the offender's consent, a standard consequence for deliberate concealment of a saṅghāvaśeṣa (Saṅgha's-remainder) transgression. The six-day probation that follows corresponds to the mānatta practice of the Mūlasarvāstivāda Vinaya tradition.

- The summary verse near the end of the first indeterminate section consists of mnemonic keywords listing the titles of the thirty forfeiture-downfall rules that follow. The verse is rendered interpretively as a versified mnemonic, preserving its telegraphic character. The individual rule-titles in the verse correspond to the rules detailed in the subsequent prose.

The phrase rendered "trustworthy laywoman" translates a Tibetan technical term for a laywoman whose testimony is accepted as reliable by the Saṅgha in legal proceedings — a specific Vinaya category.

The passage ends mid-sentence, indicating the text continues beyond this excerpt.

- The phrase rendered "venerable one" in the direct speech sections translates a Tibetan honorific address used by laypeople to monastics; it is more literally "long-lived one," a conventional form of respectful address. The term rendered "merchant chief" and "caravan leader" reflect distinct Tibetan terms for two types of prominent lay figures in the mercantile world. The passage is a continuous Vinaya rule text and the transition at the end is a deliberate mid-sentence break in the source.

- The term rendered "khoba wool" translates a Tibetan term for a reddish-brown or mixed color of sheep's wool; the precise identity of this fiber category is debated in commentarial literature but the contrast with pure black and pure white wool is the doctrinal point. The "Sugata's measure" refers to a canonical unit of linear measurement associated with the Buddha's body, used in Vinaya contexts to standardize robe and mat dimensions. The phrase "ānandāpindika" in the Tibetan is rendered from kun dga'i ra ba pa, literally "one of Anāthapiṇḍada's park," referring to a steward associated with the Jeta Grove benefactor Anāthapiṇḍada; this is a conventional Vinaya term for a class of lay steward.

- The term rendered "the last month of autumn" translates a standard Vinaya reference to the final ten days of the autumn season before the robe-offering period begins; some editions handle the counting differently, but the ten-day period is consistent across traditions. The phrase rendered "with fewer than five cracks" follows the standard Vinaya criterion for when an almsbowl is considered still serviceable. The "great cloth of the rains-retreat robe" at the close refers to the kaṭhina cloth or its equivalent in this Vinaya tradition; the Tibetan "ras chen" literally means "great cloth" and is the standard term for the ceremonial robe distributed after the rains retreat.

- The term མོན་པ་ལྟ་བུ་མཁན་པོ་, rendered here as "monks who hold the Mātṛkā," refers to masters of the Abhidharma summary matrices. Some scholars read མོན་པ་ as a Tibetan rendering of Sanskrit Mātṛkā in the sense of the numerical or categorical summaries that became the Abhidharma; this is the standard Vinaya usage.

The final sentence of the passage is notably compressed and shifts abruptly into second-person address, following the pattern of a formal charge or accusation read out at the Poṣadha. The translation preserves this rhetorical shift.

- The "Sugata's height-measure" (མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་) is a traditional unit of linear measurement based on the span or cubit of the Sugata's body, used as a standard for monastic furnishings and robes throughout the Vinaya. The exact conversion is not fixed in this passage and is left as a relative measure per the text.

The term རྩེ་ལྟ་བུ་ is rendered "trestle-bed" following the Vinaya context; it refers to a collapsible or framed bed support, distinct from the ordinary chair or stool mentioned earlier.

- The phrase rendered "without having previously wandered through" for མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་ is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan. The sense appears to be that the monk has not first inspected or become acquainted with those frightening dwelling-places before eating outside the park, making his act a breach of the relevant rule. This reading follows the parallel structure with the preceding rule.

The summary verse is a mnemonic enumeration of the rules in the preceding section. The numbers given in the verse correspond to sub-categories discussed in the full Vinaya text; the verse is meant as an aide-mémoire, and the groupings are doctrinal-technical rather than poetic.

- The summary verse in the middle of the passage is a mnemonic verse enumerating the categories of training rules that follow; it has been rendered as verse accordingly. The verse's enumeration does not always align precisely with the surrounding prose rules, which is a common feature of such Vinaya summary verses. The term rendered "mound as if arranging a stupa" reflects the Tibetan idiom of piling food conically in the bowl, likened to a stupa shape. The phrase "without separating out grains" refers to picking choice grains out from other food to eat them separately. "Topknot" renders the Tibetan term for braided hair twisted up and secured, a common lay hairstyle of the period.

- The seven procedures for settling disputes (adhikaraṇaśamatha) are here rendered by their descriptive outcomes rather than their technical Sanskrit names, following the Tibetan. The key terms are: direct confrontation (Skt. sammukhāvinaya), recollection (Skt. smṛtvinaya), non-intoxication or non-madness (Skt. amūḍhavinaya), the principle of the many (Skt. yebhuyyasikāvinaya), searching out the essential nature or "acting on acknowledgment of offence" (Skt. tatsvabhāvaiṣīyavinaya), spreading of grass (Skt. tṛṇastārakavinaya), and acknowledgment (Skt. paṭiññātakaraṇa). The summary verse abbreviates these seven in condensed form.

The final half-verse is left open-ended as it is in the Tibetan, clearly continuing into the next passage.

- The closing colophon names the translation team responsible for the Tibetan rendering of the Sarvāstivāda Prātimokṣa Sūtra. "Lha Btsan-po" in the colophon is a royal epithet referring to the Tibetan imperial patron under whose authority the translation was commissioned; "Jīnamitra" is the Sanskrit name of the Indian paṇḍita, and "Cogro Klu'i-rgyal-mtshan" is the Tibetan lo tsā ba. The list of seven buddhas follows the traditional enumeration of the Seven Buddhas of Antiquity culminating in Śākyamuni, though the verse here addresses Śākyamuni directly with several epithets rather than naming all seven individually. The phrase rendered

"God above gods" renders lha yi lha, a standard epithet meaning "deity of the deities," applied to the Buddha as supreme over all divine beings.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.